Level 5 Adult ESL Curriculum · Lesson 3 (Week 3): I Wish I Had Asked

Status: Published. Listening audio, lesson pages, and teacher slides are ready.

Date: October 2026

Audience: Program coordinators and volunteer teachers

Companion files: `images/` (12 vocabulary pictures + `images/CREDITS_L5_L3.md`). Listening audio: `L5_L3_listening.mp3` (1:23).

> **Topic:** Mild regrets about class, a work schedule, or a sign-up deadline. Learners say what they wish were true now, what they wish they had done, and one sentence about a different past.

How this lesson is organized

Part	What's inside	Who uses it
Teacher Plan	At a glance, the clock, steps, the listening script, the answer key	Volunteer teachers
Student Pages	Opening Talk, New Words, Listening, Grammar, Talk Time, Homework, Read & Write, Exit Ticket	Learners
Picture Credits	Picture and license lines	Coordinators

TEACHER PLAN

Lesson 3 (Week 3)

I Wish I Had Asked

At a glance · Clock · Steps · Script and answer key

How to Use This Plan

> **Teach in English.** You do not need to speak the learners' languages. Show the picture and point to the grammar box. There is no contrast-tip box.

> **One main point tonight.** Model it, check it, then go.

> **Cards stay on class, work schedules, and sign-ups. Do not grade the feeling. No cards about family loss, money trouble, or leaving a country.**

Lesson 3 (Week 3): I Wish I Had Asked

At a glance

By the end of class, you can do these things.

Objectives: learners can…

- I can say I wish I had… for a past regret.
- I can say I wish I knew… for something I want now.
- I can say one If I had…, I would have… sentence.
- I can say what I will do next time.

Materials

- Student pages for Lesson 3 (print the number you expect + 3 spares)
- Board and markers
- Listening: `L5_L3_listening.mp3` (1:23). Play it two times. No speaker? Read the script aloud with a volunteer.
- **Prep time:** 15 minutes

Key vocabulary (with pictures on the New Words page)

★ wish • ★ regret • ★ calendar • ★ reminder • ★ alarm • ★ sign-up sheet • ★ tutor • ★ practice • ★ question • ★ choice • help desk • next time

Clock-time plan

Time	Step	Min
6:00–6:06	Opening Talk	6
6:06–6:12	New Words	6
6:12–6:32	Listening. Task A on play 1. Tasks B and C on play 2.	20
6:32–6:45	Grammar	13
6:45–7:00	Break	15
7:00–7:18	Talk Time	18
7:18–7:25	Read & Write	7
7:25–7:30	Exit ticket and homework	5

Step by step

- **6:00 Opening.** Work with a partner. Ask about last week. Then switch.
- **6:06 New words.** Look, listen, repeat. Then the partner game.
- **Check the meaning:** "Is a calendar a list of dates?" (yes) • "What can wake you up?" (an alarm) • "Where can you ask for help?" (the help desk).
- **6:12 Listening.** After class, Alicia and Chris talk about a workshop they signed up for late. They wish they had asked sooner. Play 1: Task A. Play 2: Tasks B and C.
- **Hear it.** *gonna* and *wanna* are short forms. This listening uses the full forms. Say *going to* and *want to*.
- **6:32 Grammar.** Read across. A reads the question. B says the answer.
- **Pair check.** A says a mild regret from class. B says I wish I had… and Next time I will…. Then switch.
- **7:00 Talk Time.** Round 1, then round 2. Stop at 7:18.
- **Class size.** 15 learners: 7 pairs + 1 group of 3. 7–8 learners: 3–4 pairs. 5 or fewer: pairs, or one group with you.
- **7:18 Read & Write.** Read once. Then answer. Start the writing in class.
- **7:25 Exit.** Write about one mild regret. Four sentences. Collect the page.
- **Cards stay on class, work schedules, and sign-ups. Do not grade the feeling. No cards about family loss, money trouble, or leaving a country.**

Listening script

Audio is recorded (about 1:23). Read it with volunteers at a natural, friendly speed. The spoken lines use *going to* and *want to*. *gonna* and *wanna* are short forms. This listening uses the full forms.

Narrator: Lesson three. After class, Alicia and Chris talk about a workshop. They signed up late.
Alicia: I want to take the workshop, but the sign-up sheet was already full.
Chris: I am going to be honest. I wish I had set an alarm.
Alicia: I wish I knew the deadline sooner. I wish I had asked the tutor on Monday.
Chris: If you had asked, you would have known.
Alicia: Yes. If I had asked, I would have known. I should have asked earlier.
Chris: I wish I had put a reminder on my calendar. The alarm on my phone was off.
Alicia: Next time I will ask on the first day.
Chris: I am going to put the reminder on the calendar tonight.
Alicia: If I had another chance, I would ask on the first day. I would not wait.
Chris: If I had set the alarm, I would have arrived on time to sign up.
Alicia: We can still practice. I want to bring one question next week.
Chris: Good. Let us ask at the help desk if we are not sure which choice to make.
Alicia: I am going to write the next step before I leave.
Narrator: They choose a next step. The regret stays small. It is only about the sign-up.
Narrator: That's the end of the listening.

Answer key

- *Check the meaning:* 1 yes, 2 an alarm, 3 the help desk.
- *Listening Task A:* **b** (They signed up for the workshop late.)
- *Listening Task B:* 1 asked the tutor, 2 set an alarm, 3 ask on the first day, 4 would have known.
- *Listening Task C:* 1 wish I had, 2 would have, 3 wish I had, 4 would have, 5 would have, 6 wish I had.
- *Grammar Practice A:* 1 knew, 2 had, 3 would, 4 should, 5 will, 6 had.
- *Grammar Practice B:* 1 knew, 2 had asked, 3 had asked, 4 should have asked, 5 will ask, 6 would ask.
- *Read & Write B:* 1 The workshop sign-up., 2 I wish I knew the deadline., 3 I wish I had asked the tutor., 4 If I had asked, I would have known., 5 Ask on the first day..
- *Exit ticket:* answers will vary. A good answer uses tonight's grammar.

Teacher notes

- **Cards stay on class, work schedules, and sign-ups. Do not grade the feeling. No cards about family loss, money trouble, or leaving a country.**
- **Any next step with a reason is a good answer.**
- **Reductions:** the listening says *going to* and *want to*. People often say *gonna* and *wanna*. Learners only need to recognize the short forms.

- **All names, places, and numbers are invented.**

STUDENT WORKBOOK

Lesson 3 (Week 3)

I Wish I Had Asked

Opening Talk · New Words · Listening · Grammar · Talk Time · Homework · Read & Write · Exit Ticket

Lesson 3 (Week 3) · Opening Talk

Name: _____ Date: _____

Work with a partner. Ask about last week. Then switch.

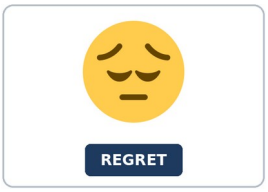
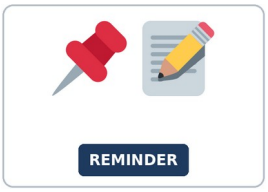
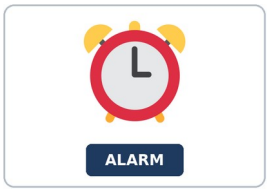
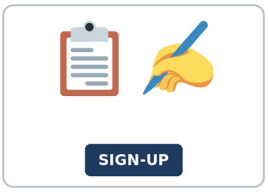
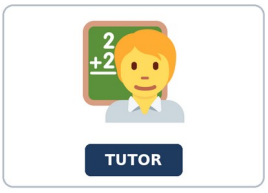
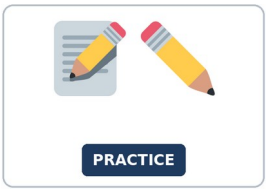
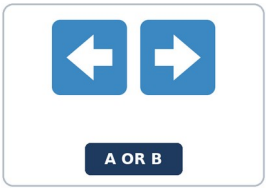
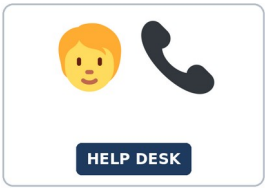
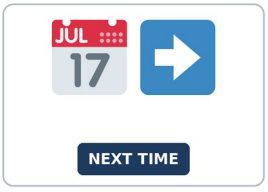
1. What had you already finished before class?
2. Say one earlier event with had.
3. Say the later event with by the time.
4. Homework check: read one sentence from your Lesson 2 note.

Lesson 3 (Week 3): I Wish I Had Asked

Name: _____ Date: _____

New Words

Look. Listen. Repeat. ★ = most important words.

 ★ **wish**	 ★ **regret**	 ★ **calendar**	 ★ **reminder**
 ★ **alarm**	 ★ **sign-up sheet**	 ★ **tutor**	 ★ **practice**
 ★ **question**	 ★ **choice**	 **help desk**	 **next time**

Partner game: Point and wish

Example: A points to a picture. B names it and uses it in one sentence. Then switch.

Lesson 3 (Week 3) · Listening

After class, Alicia and Chris talk about a workshop they signed up for late. They wish they had asked sooner.

A. Listen. What do they regret? Circle.

a. They lost a book. **b.** They signed up for the workshop late. **c.** They want to leave the class.

B. Listen again. Circle the answers.

1. Alicia's wish (**asked the tutor** / **left the class** / **skipped practice**)
2. Chris's wish (**set an alarm** / **changed jobs** / **missed the class**)
3. Next time Alicia will (**ask on the first day** / **wait a year** / **stay quiet**)
4. The if sentence uses (**would have known** / **will know** / **knew**)

C. Listen again. Write wish I had or would have.

1. Alicia: "I _____ asked the tutor."
2. "If I had asked, I _____ known the date."
3. Chris: "I _____ set an alarm."
4. "If I had set one, I _____ arrived on time."
5. Alicia: "Then I _____ known."
6. Chris: "I _____ put a reminder on the calendar."

Hear it, say it

gonna and *wanna* are short forms. This listening uses the full forms. You can say *going to* and *want to*.

In I wish I had asked, say the full had. In I would ask next time, say the full would. Say each line two times.

1. I want to ask the tutor.
2. I am going to sign up on the first day.
3. I wish I had asked.

4. If I had asked, I would have known.

Lesson 3 (Week 3) · Grammar

Read across. A reads the question. B says the answer.

Grammar Box 1: a wish about now

WISH	MEANING
I wish I **knew** the deadline.	a wish about now
I wish I **had** a reminder.	had means owned
I wish I **were** on the list.	were, for now

Grammar Box 2: a wish about the past

WISH	MEANING
I wish I **had asked** the tutor.	a past regret
I wish I **had set** an alarm.	had + participle
I wish we **had signed** up on Monday.	the sign-up is finished

Grammar Box 3: one different past

IF	RESULT
If I **had asked**, I **would have known**.	one pattern
If he **had set** an alarm, he **would have arrived** on time.	same pattern
If we **had read** the reminder, we **would have signed** up.	same pattern

Grammar Box 4: should have, and next time

NOW	NEXT
I **should have asked** earlier.	same idea as the wish
Next time I **will ask** on the first day.	a plan
If I **had** another chance, I **would ask**.	next time

Rule of thumb: A wish about now uses a past verb (knew, had, were). A wish about the past uses had + participle. After If I had + participle, the other half is would have + participle.

Practice A: Write the missing word.

1. I wish I _____ the deadline.
2. I wish I _____ asked the tutor.
3. If I had asked, I _____ have known.
4. I _____ have asked earlier.
5. Next time I _____ ask on the first day.
6. I wish I _____ a reminder.

Practice B: Circle the correct words.

1. I wish I (**knew** / **know**)
2. I wish I (**had asked** / **would have asked**)
3. If I (**had asked** / **would have asked**)
4. I (**should have asked** / **should asked**)
5. Next time I (**will ask** / **would have ask**)
6. If I had another chance, I (**would ask** / **would have asked**)

Common mistakes

Don't say	Say
I wish I would have asked.	I wish I had asked.
If I would have asked, I would have known.	If I had asked, I would have known.
I wish I know the deadline.	I wish I knew the deadline.
I should asked earlier.	I should have asked earlier.

Pair check

A says a mild regret from class. B says I wish I had… and Next time I will…. Then switch.

Lesson 3 (Week 3) · Talk Time: Wish Cards

Round 1. Pairs. Use a mild card from class or a sign-up.

1. I missed the sign-up.
2. I did not ask for the example.
3. I arrived after the explanation.

Lesson 3 (Week 3) · Talk Time: One Different Past

Round 2. Pairs. Add one if sentence. Then switch.

1. Say If I had…, I would have….
2. The group repeats the clearest sentence.
3. Name the next step.

Lesson 3 (Week 3) · Homework

Homework (about 20–25 minutes). Bring it next week!

1. Write I wish I knew and one past wish.

2. Finish the six-sentence note from Read & Write.

3. Tell a friend one next step. Write the sentence.

4. Review: had already. Write one sentence from Lesson 2.

Lesson 3 (Week 3) · Read & Write

A. Read. *Read once. Then find the answers.*

A note from the tutor

You missed the workshop sign-up. This note is from the class tutor. It is practice for class. It is not a grade. It is not about your family, your money, or a job. The problem is small. The sign-up date passed before you wrote your name on the sheet.

Start with a wish about now. You can say, "I wish I knew the deadline." Knew is a past form, and it talks about right now. You do not know the deadline today. You can also say, "I wish I had a reminder on my calendar." In that sentence, had means owned. It is not the regret form. A third line is, "I wish I were on the list." Were is the form we use after wish when we mean now.

Then say a wish about the past. "I wish I had asked the tutor." The asking is finished, and you are sorry you did not do it. Do not say, "I wish I would have asked." After wish, a past regret uses had plus the past participle. Had asked, had set, and had signed are the forms for tonight.

One different past is enough. "If I had asked, I would have known." The if half uses had plus a participle. The other half uses would have plus a participle. You do not need every person, and you do not need both clause orders. One clear sentence is the goal. Chris can say, "If I had set an alarm, I would have arrived on time."

You can put the same idea in a shorter line. "I should have asked earlier." That line is one row in the grammar box. It is not a new lesson. It means the same thing as the wish about the past. Use it once, then move to the next step.

Next time, make a plan you can do. "Next time I will ask on the first day." You can also say, "If I had another chance, I would ask on the first day." Put a reminder on the calendar. Set an alarm the day before. Bring one question to practice. If you are not sure which choice to make, ask at the help desk.

B. Answer the questions.

1. What did the learner miss? _____
2. Which wish is about now? _____
3. Which wish is about the past? _____
4. What is the if sentence? _____

5. What will the learner do next time?

_____

C. Write a 6-sentence note to yourself. One wish about now, one wish about the past, one If I had sentence, and what you will do next time.

Lesson 3 (Week 3) · Exit Ticket

Name: _____ Date: _____

Write about one mild regret. Four sentences.

The wish, the if sentence, what you should have done, and the next step. Then give this page to your teacher.

My answer

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Listening audio: `L5_L3_listening.mp3` (1:23). The voices are computer-generated. No recordings of real people. The names and the story are invented.

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